

ed to grow at a CAGR of 6.5% to \$231.8 million by 2028.

"India's men's luxury market is experiencing a remarkable surge, mirroring the global trend where men's luxury has overtaken women's. Domestic brands like Raghavendra Rathore, Ravi Bajaj, Shantnu & Nikhil, along with global brands like Corneliani, Zegna, etc. are leading this charge with bespoke and modern designs," says Pushpa Bector, Senior Executive Director and Business Head, DLF Retail, which operates two luxury malls in Delhi—DLF Emporio and The Chanakya.

The change has come about primarily after the pandemic. A survey by Reliance Brands Ltd (RBL) in 2022 found that the men's luxury brand portfolio grew by

46% in 2021. For women, it was only 14%. Moreover, 57% men claimed that their fashion spending had increased.

And it's not just clothes. "Accessories are seeing a major uptick and there is a lot of interest in men to wear jewelled watches as statement pieces," says Bector.

At Ethos Limited, India's largest retailer of luxury watches with 68 boutiques across the country, nearly 70% sales come from men's watches. While legacy brands from Switzerland that focus on heritage, sports and innovation continue to grow, there are newer brands such as Jacob & Co., Norqain, and Bell & Ross that are becoming popular. "There's a noticeable shift towards smaller dials, with many enthusiasts favouring 37-39 mm cases. Additionally, 18-carat gold watches are becoming increasingly popular, with both cases and bracelets crafted from gold. Limited edition pieces are also capturing attention in the market. For example, the Jacob & Co. limited editions consistently sell out due to their exclusivity and unique design," says Pranav Saboo, Managing Director and CEO of Ethos, which grew at a CAGR of 20%, closing the financial year 2023-24 at approximately ₹999 crore.

At Tata CLiQ Luxury, the customer base is split 60:40 between men and women, with men shopping for apparel, watches and accessories. "The demand for men's luxury has been growing, and it's a trend we expect to continue. Men's apparel is one of the fastest-growing and top-selling categories on the platform. As brand awareness grows and men become more invested in their personal style, there is a heightened interest in sporting the latest trends," says Gopal Asthana, CEO of fashion e-commerce platform Tata CLiQ.

ALL THAT BLING

India has a history of men wearing jewellery. Cartier is renowned for all the jewellery it made for Indian maharajas. While men may not be sporting large necklaces and brooches except may be at weddings, everyday bling is in. "According to our consumer insights, 90% of men in the 31-40 age group in top metros and Tier I cities consider precious jewellery crucial for significant occasions, highlighting the increasing importance of the jewellery category in their lives," says Vaishali Banerjee, Managing Director-India of marketing organisation Platinum Guild International (PGI). Under its Men of Platinum brand, PGI has recently launched "The MS Dhoni Signature Edition" where each piece is adorned with Dhoni's signature. Depending on the design and weight of each piece, prices for the collection range from ₹55,000 to ₹2.5 lakh. "In just five years since its launch, we have seen distribution for Men of Platinum increase



"When it comes to global brands, the men's ready-to-wear collection does much better than womenswear. The expenditure for women is more on accessories like bags and shoes"

RITESH KUMAR
DIRECTOR, DS LUXURY

